

Absolutely — **pot** is a strong target because your passage uses the **plant-container** meaning, while modern English also uses **pot** for cooking vessels, quantities of drink, pooled money, pottery, cannabis slang, and several important verb/adjective forms such as **pot a plant**, **potted plant**, **potted history**.

Word family: **pot / potted / potting / pottery / potter**

Base word: **pot**

Verb forms: **pot, pots, potted, potting**

Related forms: **pottery, potter**

Useful compounds / extensions: **plant pot, flowerpot, cooking pot, coffee pot, teapot, potting soil, potted plant, potluck, jackpot**

Part of speech: **noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / adjective-related forms (相關形容詞)**

Your sentence:

> “Even when I was young, I remember seeing little **pots** of herbs and flowers near her windows...”

Meaning in your passage: **pot = container for growing plants — 花盆 ; 盆栽容器**

Here, **pot** means:

> **a container, usually with an open top, used to hold soil and grow a plant.**

繁體中文 :

用來盛載泥土、種植花草或其他植物的容器 ; 花盆

Natural translation:

> “I remember seeing little pots of herbs and flowers near her windows.”

「我記得她家窗邊放著一些種有香草和花的小**花盆 / 盆栽**。」

Strictly:

> **pot = 花盆本身**

> **potted plant = 盆栽植物**

1. **pot + plant/flower (植物容器) — 花盆 ; 盆**

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I remember seeing little ****pots**** of herbs and flowers near her windows.”

「我記得她窗邊放著一些種有香草和花的小****花盆****。」

Practice 2

> “She moved the lemon tree into a larger ****pot****.”

「她把檸檬樹移到一個更大的****花盆****裡。」

Practice 3

> “Make sure the ****pot**** has holes for drainage.”

「要確保****花盆****有排水孔。」

****pot — plant container = 盛載泥土和植物、供植物生長的容器****

2. ****pot = cooking vessel (煮食器皿) — 鍋 ; 煲****

A major everyday meaning.

Practice 4

> “She cooked the soup in a large ****pot****.”

「她用一個大****鍋 / 煲****煮湯。」

Practice 5

> “Put the water in the pot and bring it to a boil.”

「把水倒進****鍋裡****，然後煮滾。」

****pot — cooking = 用來煮食物 / 液體、通常較深並有開口的烹飪器皿****

3. ****pot = container designed to hold/serve something (盛載器皿) — 壺 ; 罐 ; 容器****

The exact Chinese depends on what the pot is for.

Practice 6

> “She brought a **pot of tea** to the table.”

「她端了一**壺茶**到桌上。」

Practice 7

> “There was a small **pot of cream** beside the coffee.”

「咖啡旁邊有一小**壺 / 小罐忌廉**。」

pot = 用來盛載、沖泡或供應某種食物 / 飲品的小型容器

Common compounds:

* teapot = 茶壺

* coffee pot = 咖啡壺

* sugar pot = 糖罐

This shares the general “container” concept with plant pots and cooking pots, so we should **not** pretend every container type is a completely different lexical meaning.

4. **a pot of + food/drink (容器所盛的量) — 一鍋 ; 一壺 ; 一罐**

Here **pot** can measure the amount contained in the vessel.

Practice 8

> “She made a **pot of soup**.”

「她煮了**一鍋湯**。」

Practice 9

> “We shared a **pot of coffee**.”

「我們一起喝了**一壺咖啡**。」

a pot of something = 一個 pot 所能盛載的整份數量

This is a container → quantity extension.

5. **pot = small commercial container of food/cosmetics (小盒 / 小罐) — 小盒 ; 小罐**

Especially common in British English.

Practice 10

> “She had a small **pot of yoghurt**.”

「她有一小**杯 / 盒乳酪**。」

Practice 11

> “I bought a little **pot of face cream**.”

「我買了一小**罐面霜**。」

pot — packaged product = 用來裝食品、化妝品等的小型容器及其中一份產品

Register note: especially common in British English.

6. **pot = pooled money/prize fund (共同金額) — 彩池 ; 獎金池 ; 共同款項**

A genuinely distinct figurative meaning.

Practice 12

> “Everyone contributed money to the **pot**.”

「每個人都把錢放進共同的**款項 / 基金**裡。」

Practice 13

> “The winner took the entire **pot**.”

「勝出者拿走了整個**獎金池 / 彩池**。」

pot — money = 多人共同投入，之後按規則分配 / 由勝出者取得的一筆錢

Common in:

* games

* gambling contexts

* competitions
* informal shared funds

7. **jackpot (獎項) — 頭獎 ; 累積大獎**

A major lexical extension.

Practice 14

> “She won the **jackpot**.”

「她中了**頭獎 / 巨額累積獎金**。」

Practice 15

> “The machine displayed the current jackpot.”

「機器顯示目前的**累積大獎金額**。」

jackpot = 某些彩票 / 遊戲中最大或累積的獎金

Figuratively it can also mean an exceptionally lucky success:

> “We hit the jackpot with this location.”

= 我們在這個地點的選擇上**大成功 / 走大運**。

8. **pot = cannabis/marijuana (非正式) — 大麻**

A common informal lexical meaning.

Practice 16

> “The article discusses changing attitudes toward **pot**.”

「這篇文章討論人們對**大麻**態度的改變。」

Practice 17

> “In informal American English, ‘pot’ can refer to marijuana.”

「在非正式美式英語中，pot 可以指**大麻**。」

****pot — slang = marijuana/cannabis 的非正式稱呼****

Register: informal/slang.

This is a genuine lexical meaning, but unrelated to your gardening sentence despite the accidental plant connection.

9. ****pot + plant (動詞) — 把植物栽進花盆****

Now ****pot**** is a verb.

Practice 18

> “She ****potted**** the young tomato plants.”

「她把幼小番茄苗****栽進花盆****。」

Practice 19

> “These herbs are ready to be ****potted****.”

「這些香草已經可以****移栽到花盆裡****了。」

****pot a plant = 把植物放入裝有泥土的花盆中栽種****

10. ****potted plant (植物) — 盆栽植物****

A very useful family form for your passage.

Practice 20

> “She keeps several ****potted plants**** near the window.”

「她在窗邊放了幾盆****盆栽植物****。」

Practice 21

> “Potted plants need regular watering.”

「****盆栽植物****需要定期澆水。」

****potted plant = 種植在花盆中而非直接種在地裡的植物****

Important:

> pot = 花盆

> potted plant = 盆栽植物

11. ****potting soil / potting mix (園藝) — 盆栽土 ; 培養土****

A directly useful gardening compound.

Practice 22

> “Use fresh ****potting soil**** for the herbs.”

「種香草時使用新鮮的****盆栽土 / 培養土****。」

Practice 23

> “This potting mix drains well.”

「這種****盆栽培養土****排水良好。」

****potting soil/mix = 專門配製供花盆 / 容器種植植物使用的栽培介質****

12. ****pottery = pots and other objects made from clay — 陶器 ; 陶製品****

A major family extension.

Practice 24

> “The museum displays ancient ****pottery****.”

「博物館展出古代****陶器****。」

Practice 25

> “She collects handmade pottery.”

「她收藏手工****陶器****。」

****pottery = 用陶土燒製的器皿 / 物品作為整體類別****

Usually uncountable in this sense.

13. **pottery = craft/activity of making clay objects — 陶藝；製陶**

Practice 26

> “She takes a **pottery** class on Saturdays.”

「她星期六上**陶藝課**。」

Practice 27

> “Pottery requires patience and practice.”

「**陶藝 / 製陶**需要耐性和練習。」

****pottery = 用陶土塑形並燒製器物的工藝 / 活動****

So ****pottery**** itself has at least two useful uses:

* 陶器

* 陶藝 / 製陶

14. **potter = person who makes pottery — 陶工；陶藝家**

Practice 28

> “The bowl was made by a local **potter**.”

「這隻碗由一位本地**陶藝家 / 陶工**製作。」

Practice 29

> “The potter shaped the clay by hand.”

「**陶工**用手塑造陶泥。」

****potter — noun = 以陶土製作器物的人****

15. **pot = sink a ball into a pocket/hole (桌球 / 撞球) — 把球擊入袋中**

A genuinely distinct sports verb.

Practice 30

> “He **potted** the final ball and won the match.”

「他把最後一球**擊入袋中**，贏得比賽。」

Practice 31

> “She failed to pot the red ball.”

「她未能把紅球**擊入球袋**。」

pot a ball = 在桌球 / 撞球中把球擊進球袋

Especially common in British English with snooker/pool.

16. **pot = score by putting a ball into a target/hole (球類) — 擊入；入球**

A broader sports extension of #15, though much less central.

Practice 32

> “He calmly **potted** the ball.”

「他冷靜地把球**擊入袋中**。」

Practice 33

> “The player had several chances to pot.”

「那位球員有幾次**把球擊入袋中的機會**。」

I would keep this under the same cue-sport sense rather than create multiple sports meanings.

17. **potted = preserved/cooked in a pot (食物) — 罐裝 / 盆裝保存的；製成肉醬的**

A traditional but still encountered food use.

Practice 34

> “The restaurant serves **potted shrimp**.”

「餐廳供應**罐裝 / 奶油封存蝦**。」

Practice 35

> “Potted meat was traditionally stored under a layer of fat.”

「傳統的**罐存肉醬 / 封存肉製品**會以脂肪層保存。」

potted food = 經烹調後放入小罐 / 盆中保存的食品

This is more common in British culinary language.

18. **potted** + history/biography/summary (簡短濃縮) — 簡略的 ; 濃縮的

A useful figurative British-English extension.

Practice 36

> “The book begins with a **potted history** of the town.”

「這本書開首先提供該城鎮的**簡略歷史概述**。」

Practice 37

> “She gave us a potted biography of the artist.”

「她向我們簡短介紹了那位藝術家的**生平概述**。」

potted + account/history/biography = 把大量資訊濃縮成簡短、概括版本的

Register: especially British English.

19. **potluck** = meal where people bring food to share — 百樂餐 ; 每人帶食物分享的聚餐

A very useful lexical extension, especially in North American English.

Practice 38

> “We’re having a **potluck** this weekend.”

「我們這個週末會舉行一場**每人帶一道食物來分享的聚餐**。」

Practice 39

> “Everyone brought a dish to the potluck.”

「每個人都帶了一道菜去參加**百樂餐 / 共享聚餐**。」

potluck = 參加者各自帶食物一起分享的聚餐

This is highly lexicalized; it should not be analysed literally as simply **pot + luck**.

Important distinction: **pot vs pan**

pot

usually:

- * deeper;
- * often has two handles/a lid;
- * suitable for boiling, soup, pasta, etc.

pan

usually:

- * shallower;
- * often has one long handle;
- * suitable for frying/sautéing.

> pot = 鍋 / 煲

> frying pan = 平底鑊 / 煎鍋

There is overlap across regional cookware terminology.

Important distinction: **pot vs plant pot vs potted plant**

pot

= container

> a pot

plant pot / flowerpot

= specifically a pot for growing plants

potted plant

= the actual plant growing inside a pot

So your sentence:

> “little pots of herbs and flowers”

means containers **holding** the herbs/flowers.

Important distinction: **pot vs container**

container

very broad:

anything designed to hold something.

pot

specific type of open/deep vessel, often for:

* plants;

* cooking;

* food/drink.

Every pot is a container, but not every container is a pot.

Important distinction: **pot vs vase**

pot

can hold soil and growing plants.

vase

normally holds cut flowers, often in water.

> flowerpot = 種花的花盆

> vase = 插切花的花瓶

This distinction matters directly in gardening.

Important distinction: **pot** vs **kettle**

pot

can cook/hold liquid or food.

kettle

specifically used mainly to boil water.

> teapot = 茶壺，用來泡 / 盛茶

> kettle = 水壺，用來煮水

Do not confuse them.

Important distinction: **pot** vs **pottery**

pot

one specific vessel.

pottery

can mean:

* pottery objects collectively;

* the craft of making them.

> “a clay pot”

> = 一個陶盆 / 陶罐

> “ancient pottery”

> = 古代陶器

Important distinction: **potter vs pottery**

potter

= person

pottery

= objects/craft

> potter = 陶工 / 陶藝家

> pottery = 陶器 / 陶藝

Important distinction: **pot — cannabis vs potted plant**

Because both can involve plants, learners may find the overlap memorable, but they are **different lexical senses**.

> **pot** = informal cannabis

> **potted plant** = plant growing in a flowerpot

There is no need to connect the meanings semantically in a learner entry.

Important distinction: **a pot of tea vs a cup of tea**

a pot of tea

= the amount held in a teapot, usually enough for several cups.

a cup of tea

= one individual cup.

> “We ordered a pot of tea.”

「我們點了一壺茶。」

Important distinction: **green thumb vs potting**

Directly relevant to your passage:

> ****green thumb****

> = ability to grow plants well

> ****potting****

> = the physical activity/process of putting plants into pots

Someone can know how to ****pot plants**** without necessarily having a legendary ****green thumb****.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* ****pot — plant container**** = 花盆

* ****pot — cooking vessel**** = 鍋 / 煲

* ****pot — serving/storage container**** = 壺 / 罐 / 容器

* ****a pot of something**** = 一鍋 / 一壺 / 一罐的量

* ****pot — packaged food/cosmetic container**** = 小盒 / 小罐

* ****pot — pooled money**** = 獎金池 / 共同款項

* ****pot — cannabis**** = 大麻

* ****pot a plant**** = 把植物栽進花盆

* ****potted plant**** = 盆栽植物

* ****potting soil/mix**** = 盆栽土 / 培養土

* ****pottery — objects**** = 陶器

* ****pottery — craft**** = 陶藝

* ****potter**** = 陶藝家 / 陶工

* ****pot — cue sports**** = 把球擊入袋

* ****potted food**** = 罐 / 盆裝保存食品

* ****potted history**** = 簡略濃縮概述

* ****potluck**** = 每人帶食物分享的聚餐

* ****jackpot**** = 頭獎 / 大獎金

I would exclude obscure historical vessels and highly specialist technical uses unless a later passage specifically requires them.

Master comparison

| Form / sense

| MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning |

| ----- | ----- |

| ****pot — plant container**** | 盛載泥土和植物、供植物生長的花盆 / 容器 |

pot — cooking vessel	用來煮食物或液體、通常較深的烹飪器皿	
pot — serving/storage container	用來盛載、沖泡或供應食物 / 飲品的壺、罐或容器	
a pot of something	一個 pot 所能盛載的一整份食物 / 飲品數量	
pot — packaged container	裝乳酪、面霜等食品 / 產品的小型容器，尤其英式英語	
pot — pooled money	多人共同投入、按規則分配或由勝者取得的一筆錢	
pot — cannabis	marijuana/cannabis 的非正式稱呼	
pot a plant	把植物移入裝有泥土的花盆中栽種	
potted plant	種植在花盆而非直接種在地裡的植物	
potting soil/mix	專供盆栽植物生長使用的栽培介質	
pottery — objects	用陶土燒製的器皿 / 物品整體	
pottery — craft	用陶土塑形並燒製器物的工藝 / 活動	
potter	以陶土製作器物的陶工 / 陶藝家	
pot — cue sports	在桌球 / 撞球中把球擊進球袋	
potted food	經烹調後放入小罐 / 盆中保存的食品	
potted history/account	把大量資料濃縮成非常簡短的概略版本	
potluck	每名參加者各自帶食物共同分享的聚餐	
jackpot	彩票 / 遊戲中最大或累積的獎金；亦可比喻意外的大成功	

For your original sentence

> “I remember seeing little ****pots**** of herbs and flowers near her windows...”

The exact meaning is:

****pot = 盛載泥土、讓香草和花生長的小型花盆****

So naturally:

> ****little pots of herbs and flowers****

= ****「一盆盆小香草和花 / 一些種著香草和花的小花盆」****

And the most useful learner contrast here is:

- > ****pot**** → 花盆本身
- > ****potted plant**** → 種在花盆裡的植物 / 盆栽
- > ****pot a plant**** → 把植物栽進花盆
- > ****potting soil**** → 盆栽用培養土
- > ****pottery**** → 陶器 / 陶藝
- > ****potter**** → 陶工 / 陶藝家